



The "Halo Halo Halo" Time Tracker API

Guide

What's up, team? This is your totally not-boring, practical guide for connecting one employee's punch status to n8n, WhatsApp, Slack, Teams, or another workflow. Yes, this is an actual API. The private URL shown on your automation page spits out JSON with your current punch status and your latest punch event.



Security: Don't Leak the Memes (or the Token)

- Treat this URL like a password and never include it in screenshots or public notes.
- If **MV** accidentally leaks the private token in a screenshot, click **Regenerate** before using it.
- Each employee creates their own URL, and the employee email is not placed in the URL.
- **Copy URL**: Copies the current private API address.
- **Regenerate**: Creates a new token and immediately disables the old URL.
- **Revoke**: Disables the personal API until a new URL is created. Use this to revoke access when an automation is no longer needed.



The Geeky Stuff: What the JSON Means

When you test the URL in a browser, a successful request returns JSON. Here are the fields used by the workflow:

- **attendance.status** : Current value is either `punched_in` or `punched_out` .
- **attendance.isPunchedIn** : Boolean value—it is `true` while you're working, and `false` after you punch out.
- **attendance.event** : The latest action (`punch_in` or `punch_out`). It can be `null` until your first new punch.
- **attendance.eventId** : A unique ID for the latest punch. *Use it to prevent duplicate messages!*
- **attendance.occurredAt** : Exact event time in ISO format.



Building the n8n "Halo Halo Halo" Machine

You are going to build a workflow that looks like this: **Schedule** → **HTTP Request** → **Remove Duplicates** → **Switch** → **Send Message**.

1. **Schedule Trigger:** Add a Schedule Trigger and set it to run once every minute. Confirm the workflow timezone is correct.
2. **HTTP Request:** Set the Method to GET. Paste your private production URL into the URL field. Set Authentication to None. Set Response format to JSON. Execute the node once and confirm that the output contains `ok`, `employee`, and `attendance`.
3. **Remove Duplicates (CRITICAL!):** Add Remove Duplicates after the HTTP Request. Compare using `{{ $json.attendance.eventId }}`. Choose comparison with previous workflow executions.

***Why this matters for Andrea's sanity:** Without cross-execution duplicate removal, a one-minute schedule can send the same good morning or goodbye message every single minute.*

4. **Switch Node:** Set the Value to `{{ $json.attendance.event }}`. Output 1 equals `punch_in`. Output 2 equals `punch_out`. Do nothing when the event is empty or null.
5. **Send the Message!:** Connect `punch_in` to WhatsApp Business Cloud, Slack, Teams, or another node. Make it say something like: "halo halo halo Good morning team! I have started my workday." Connect `punch_out` to a second message action. Make it say: "Bye team! I have finished for today."
Note: Only connect messaging credentials owned by the employee or approved for that employee's automation.



Troubleshooting (When things break)

Problem: API returns 404.

Fix: The token is wrong, revoked, regenerated, or the personal API is not deployed.

Problem: API returns 410.

Fix: The personal API was disabled. Create or regenerate it.

Problem: `attendance.event` is null.

Fix: Punch in or out once after creating the URL.

Problem: Same message repeats (Spamming "halo halo halo").

Fix: Configure Remove Duplicates across previous executions using `attendance.eventId`.

Problem: API works, no message.

Fix: Check workflow activation, message credentials, and the latest n8n execution.

When the workflow is active, a new punch changes the `eventId`. The next scheduled n8n check sees that new event and sends the matching message exactly once. Activate or publish the n8n workflow, punch in or out in Time Station, wait for the next scheduled run, and confirm exactly one message was sent!